

Windows 10 Redux

Everything you wanted to know
Microsoft's upcoming Windows
OS. Hint: It's free for all!

88

QnA

Naughty jumping cursors, SSD
power requirement confusion, and
disk cloning issues resolved

90

Workshop

Accessing all the files from a single location or service is comparatively hassle-free. To further take the edge off this task, odrive gives you a staggering 42 GB of storage space for free. Of course, though, the amount is a combination of Box (10GB), Dropbox (2GB), Google Drive (15GB) and Microsoft OneDrive (15GB). We hope odrive integrates Mega as well (it gives its users 50GB of free space). If you have multiple accounts on one of these services, then don't worry, you can connect and sync them to odrive as well, further expanding your already huge (and free) repository of cloud storage space.

Sync, unsync, be my guest

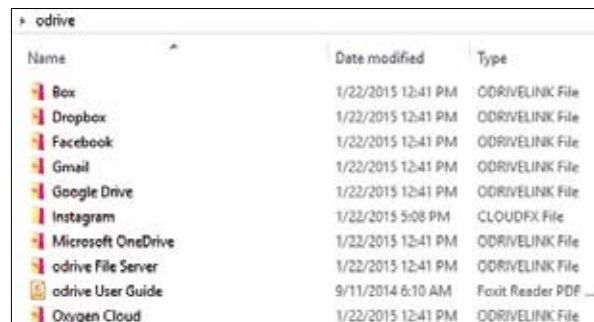
What it's calling 'Progressive Sync', and touting as a new feature, lets you choose the files you want to sync and ignore the not-so-important files. But this feature is already present in Microsoft's OneDrive and Google Drive, where there's an additional option of making the file available offline. To make files available offline in odrive, you'd have to copy them to a different folder since unsyncing a file removes it from your folder. But again, this feature might not be available on other services, and having to control all the services using selective sync from one single location is definitely better. Selective sync further lets you save plenty of storage space, letting you choose only files that you do want to be available on your hard drive.

After connecting a service, open up the folder and all the files within it will be listed. You can then go ahead and pick the files/folders you want to sync. If you think that you don't need a particular file/folder, you could right-click and unsync it. Unsyncing files frees up hard drive space, and is recommended for users who don't have much storage space available on their hard drives.

Download all your photos from Facebook and Instagram

Apart from syncing your files from various cloud storage services, odrive has an interesting feature – it lets you automatically download all your uploaded photos from your Facebook albums and

Instagram account. Though Facebook gives you the option of mailing an archive of all your photos, the advantage here is that you can select which album you want to download. This is a great feature since most of us have hundreds of photos uploaded on the social network. All you need to do is connect your Facebook account and head over to the Facebook folder on your local drive where you'll see all your albums listed as folders. Right-click to select which ones you want to sync. All your photos would be sorted automatically by year, so you won't have a hard time searching for your photos.



Name	Date modified	Type
Box	1/22/2015 12:41 PM	ODRIVELINK File
Dropbox	1/22/2015 12:41 PM	ODRIVELINK File
Facebook	1/22/2015 12:41 PM	ODRIVELINK File
Gmail	1/22/2015 12:41 PM	ODRIVELINK File
Google Drive	1/22/2015 12:41 PM	ODRIVELINK File
Instagram	1/22/2015 5:08 PM	CLOUDFX File
Microsoft OneDrive	1/22/2015 12:41 PM	ODRIVELINK File
odrive File Server	1/22/2015 12:41 PM	ODRIVELINK File
odrive User Guide	9/11/2014 6:10 AM	Foxit Reader PDF ...
Oxygen Cloud	1/22/2015 12:41 PM	ODRIVELINK File

Sync your services and files

odrive also lets you download all the pictures you've uploaded to Instagram. Natively, Instagram doesn't give you any option to download your pictures but there are third-party apps that let you do that. odrive, however, not only downloads your pictures but also the pictures you've liked using the social account. Another sweet feature included for Instagram lets you download photos with a certain hashtag. For example, if you want to download photos hashtagged #Cat uploaded to Instagram, you can select the 'Add Hashtag Folder' by right-clicking on the Instagram folder. This feature becomes really useful for brands who create hashtags specifically for an event or promotion, and want to download all the photos uploaded with that hashtag.

Retrieve your Gmail attachments

Say you don't want to go through the pain of searching for an attachment someone sent you on Gmail, is there an easier way? odrive saves you from the ordeal of scavenging through the endless threads of

mail by downloading all the attachments sent to you. Once you connect your Gmail account, your Gmail folder will have a 'Labels' and 'Senders' folder. Labels will sync all attachments sent to you under the Labels that you might have created in your Gmail account. The Senders folder will have folders of people (email addresses) that have sent you attachments. An additional feature here is when you're viewing your attachment, you could view the exact email in which the attachment was sent by right-clicking on the file and selecting 'Open in Gmail'. Another interesting feature to help you be organised.

Possible improvements

Being in beta stage, the service will have many improvements later. On trying out the service, we came across a few kinks that should be ironed out. Here's hoping that odrive is listening. For example, after your Facebook albums or Instagram

photos are synced, unsynced photos don't have thumbnails. Thumbnails are obviously generated when the file is present in your hard drive, but having a preview available would be great so that we could actually look at what we're syncing. Integrating Google+ photos would again be a great feature if all photos clicked from our phone's camera were available to be synced to our hard drive. There's a walk-through to change the default location of your odrive folder, but isn't recommended and we'd appreciate if this feature was included in the next update.

After using odrive for a couple of weeks, we've found the service to be quite helpful. For those who can't afford paid cloud services storage, this certainly seems like a life saver. If you can afford the cost, given that cloud storage fees have dropped drastically recently, subscribing to a premium service would further expand the storage size one can have on odrive. Keeping your cloud storage organised and efficient is one thing odrive does well and you should definitely give it a whirl. 